

The Elite

There aren't enough 22-inch and above LCDs in the market for us to pit against each other, so we'll look at each of these big ones individually

BenQ

The FP241W is part of a small community of large, 1080p supporting, widescreen LCDs based on Samsung's excellent S-PVA panel technology. Other members of this exclusive club include Dell's 2407WFP, Samsung's own 244T and Acer's AL2423Wdr.

The FP241W is a huge monitor, with an intimidating stand—well in keeping with such a large screen. It sports an ultra large resolution of 1920x1200 pixels, and a whopping luminance of 500 Cd/m². The contrast ratio of 1000:1 means you won't be missing out on any of the action—be it movies or games. And that's the kind of user who will appreciate this kind of monitor—the enthusiast.

It blazed through all our tests, shaming all other monitors across all the other categories. While calibrating it using DisplayMate, we could see all the grey shaded cards, despite the background being absolutely black—only NEC's 1990FX came that close—this speaks volumes for the contrast ratio. The viewing angles are also excellent, with absolutely no colour distortion while changing horizontal and vertical viewing angles—this is a characteristic of PVA panels.

Watching movies was a pleasure on this monitor, and it's viewable from quite a distance (courtesy its large screen). Gaming buffs will drool at

the prospect of playing games on such a monitor—absolutely glorious colour (native 8-bit) and excellent contrast—we tried our hands at *FarCry*, *F.E.A.R.*, *Company of Heroes*, *Oblivion* and *S.T.A.L.K.E.R.* and were very impressed.

BenQ's imbued the FP241W with a lot of nifty features—height adjustment, portrait mode (goodbye to web page scrolling), and the regular horizontal and vertical swivel. The build quality of the moving parts is right up with the best. The bezel is also

very slim for a monitor this size.

The FP241W features S-Video, Component and even HDMI connectivity on the video front, besides the mandatory DVI and D-Sub inputs—a host of connectivity options, to be sure. Four USB ports are also provided.

At Rs 49,990 the BenQ FP241W isn't cheap. In fact, it's nearly the price of a 32-inch LCD TV. You do get immense functionality though, not to mention a huge resolution advantage. If you happen to be one of those rich blokes who's LCD shopping, just close your eyes and whip out your cheque book!

Price (Rupees)—49,990



RATINGS

Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Dell E228WFP

Acres Of Fun

Dell's E228WFP is one of their value series monitors, (which in Dell-speak means it's based on a budget panel technology—TN). Nonetheless, it's a very capable LCD with a lot of screen area to offer.

At a resolution of 1680x1050 pixels the E228WFP is all about widescreen satisfaction. A contrast ratio of 800:1 and a luminance of 300 Cd/m² will see it through most applications with ease.

The monitor comes with Dell's usually exemplary stand—we've been impressed by this before.

Featuring digital and analog inputs, the E228WFP ran into some problems in DisplayMate's 64-intensity test for primary colours, where the first four intensities looked identical!

Mysteriously, this problem didn't persist in the 16-intensity test or the 256-intensity ramp.

Movie-watching is good on the E228WFP, with none of DisplayMate's con-

cerns rearing their heads here, though the contrast doesn't even begin to approach the exemplary FP241W. It's an unfair comparison, however—S-PVA is definitely a superior panel technology than TN.

F.E.A.R. and *Oblivion* looked good with crisp colours and good HDR



effects. The E228WFP makes a strong statement for a gaming monitor for gamers who need the additional 2-inches of real estate it offers.

Image and rendering professionals should look—at the FP241W or NEC's 1990FX/1970NXp duo, or Dell's very own UltraSharp series, though—unfortunately, this is a 6-bit panel and not suited for such tasks.

Price (Rupees)—26,000

RATINGS

Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★